

Build Steps

Cowork is task-driven — give Copilot a job, optionally schedule it, let it use your M365.

1 Open Copilot Cowork

Open Microsoft 365 Copilot and switch to Cowork mode (left rail). Confirm the surfaces you have available — Cowork can act on your behalf across:

- Outlook (read, summarise, draft, send, schedule)
- Teams (chats, channels, post messages, read history)
- Calendar (find times, create meetings, prep briefs)
- SharePoint & OneDrive (read files, write Word/Excel/PowerPoint to your files)
- Power BI (semantic models, reports, DAX queries)

2 Paste the Headline Task

Open a new Cowork task and paste the prompt below. This is the worked example for IT — adapt names, channels, and Power BI reports to your tenant before running.

Every weekday at 9:00am, run the IT Channel Triage:

1. Read the last 24 hours of messages in the 'IT Support' Teams channel and the #ask-it chat.
2. Group them into: password / access, hardware, software, network, security. Count each.
3. Identify questions that have been asked 3+ times in the last 30 days — these are candidates for a KB article.
4. Post a summary to the 'IT Leadership' Teams channel with the counts, the top 3 recurring questions, and any unanswered message older than 4 hours.
5. For each unanswered message older than 4 hours, draft a reply suggesting the most likely fix — leave drafts for the on-call IT agent to send.

3 Set the Schedule

In the task panel, choose Schedule and configure:

Frequency	Weekdays
Run Time	09:00 GMT (start of working day)
Execution Mode	Inline (recommended) — task remembers context across runs

4 Verify the First Run

Run once now (Run now) before scheduling kicks in. Confirm:

- It read both the channel and the chat (not just one)
- Recurring-question detection works — try planting a duplicate
- The leadership channel post has the right counts and links
- Draft replies are technically sensible and reference your KB

Try These Live

Copy any of these into a new Cowork task — one-shot or scheduled.

Weekly Trend Deck

Every Friday at 4pm: search my mailbox and the IT channel for access/permission tickets in the last 7 days. Identify the top 3 patterns. Build a 4-slide PowerPoint (title, top patterns, what's driving them, 3 actions for next week). Email it to the IT leads. Leave the email as a draft.

Service Desk Dashboard Read-out

Read the 'IT Service Desk' Power BI report. Summarise SLA Met % by priority, top 3 categories by volume, agents at risk of breach. Build a one-page Word brief and email it to the IT manager. Cite the report visuals you used.

Outage Postmortem Pack

We had an outage on the date I'll paste. Pull all related Teams messages, emails, and channel posts. Build a timeline Word doc: detection, first response, resolution, root cause (if mentioned), and 3 action items.

How to Think About This Teammate

Cowork replaces:

- Manually scrolling 8 IT channels each morning
- Forgetting recurring questions until KB review week
- Hand-built Friday IT readouts

With:

- ✓ A 9am triage digest, every weekday
- ✓ Recurring-question signal in real time
- ✓ Friday decks and Word briefs drafted, not built

Not a chatbot. A scheduled teammate with full access to your M365.

Tip for real-world use

Cowork can post Adaptive Cards to Teams that include action buttons. Ask it to render the leadership-channel digest as a card with counts as visual badges — much higher signal for execs scrolling on mobile than a wall of text.

You've built a Cowork teammate ✓

You now have a Copilot teammate that can:

- Triage channels at scale
- Auto-draft KB-quality replies
- Catch recurring questions before they pile up
- Build dashboards & decks without busywork